

UNITED NATIONS  NATIONS UNIES  
DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS

ITALIAN FELLOWSHIPS PROGRAMME  
FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION  
CAPACITY BUILDING AND HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT  
2025-2026

**Fellowship Award Specification**

**Food and Agriculture Organization of United Nations (FAO)  
Partnership and Liaison Office in Kazakhstan**

**1. General Information**

|                                       |                                                        |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| <u>Title:</u>                         | UN Fellow                                              |
| <u>Orientation Workshop dates:</u>    | May 2026 (tbc)                                         |
| <u>Assignment in the field dates:</u> | May 2026 – May 2027 (tbc)                              |
| <u>Duty Station:</u>                  | Astana, Kazakhstan                                     |
| <u>Sector of assignment:</u>          | Water Resources Management and Sustainable Agriculture |

**2. Supervision**

|                                        |                                                                   |
|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <u>Name of the Supervisor:</u>         | Ms. Zhanyl Bozayeva                                               |
| <u>Title of the Supervisor:</u>        | Programme Officer, Team Leader FAO Kazakhstan                     |
| <u>Name of the Direct Supervisor</u>   | Ms. Aizhan Karabayeva                                             |
| <u>Title of the Direct Supervisor:</u> | National Project Coordinator/PPG Coordinator and Technical Expert |

**3. Background information**

The Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) is a specialized agency of the United Nations that leads international efforts to defeat hunger. Our goal is to achieve food security for all and make sure that people have regular access to enough high-quality food to lead active, healthy lives.

FAO Kazakhstan office is involved in various projects aimed at enhancing food security and agricultural sustainability. These projects encompass a wide range of activities focused on improving agricultural practices, promoting sustainable fisheries and aquaculture, and ensuring environmental sustainability. The office collaborates with local communities, government agencies, and international partners to implement innovative solutions and best practices in agriculture. These initiatives include providing technical assistance, conducting research, and developing policies to support sustainable development. FAO Kazakhstan also focuses on capacity building and training programs to empower farmers with the knowledge and skills needed to improve productivity and resilience. Additionally, the office is committed to supporting rural development and improving the livelihoods of vulnerable populations. Through these efforts, FAO Kazakhstan contributes to achieving food security, reducing poverty, and fostering sustainable economic growth in the region.

In regard to this assignment, FAO Kazakhstan is supporting activities on Integrated Water Resources Management (IWRM) and Sustainable Land Management (SLM) to enhance resilience of agriculture and ecosystems to climate change, land degradation, and water scarcity. Technical support is required to strengthen analysis, planning, and knowledge sharing in the water sector, and to assist national partners in adopting integrated and sustainable practices.

#### **4. Duties, responsibilities and output expectations:**

Within the framework of the Fellowships Programme for Technical Cooperation Capacity Building and Human Resources Development, the candidate will perform the following duties:

1. Collect and review data on water management systems, water use practices, and related policies.
2. Assist in preparing summaries, case studies, or technical briefs.
3. Support the team in applying water resources management, irrigation, watershed and catchment management tools, etc.
4. Contribute to drafting simple notes or background papers on water and salinity issues.
5. Help organize workshops, trainings, and knowledge-sharing sessions.
6. Prepare supporting materials (presentations, handouts, summaries).
7. Assist in communicating with local stakeholders and farmers (under guidance).
8. Support preparation of advisory materials on good water-use practices.
9. Carry out other support functions as required by the supervisor.

#### **5. Qualifications and Experience**

##### Education

Advanced university degree in water resources, environmental sciences, agriculture, or related field.

##### Work experience

Some prior experience in areas related to natural resource management, agriculture, environmental science, water resources, climate change, or rural development is desirable. Experience may include internships, academic research, volunteer work, or participation in development projects.

##### Languages

Fluency in English language is required.

Working knowledge of Russian language would be an asset.

##### Other skills

- Advanced skills in Microsoft Office Suite (Excel, PowerPoint, Word) and other data analysis tools.
- Strong research, writing, and organizational skills.
- Basic knowledge of IWRM/SLM principles is an asset.

### Competencies

- Adaptability and Flexibility - the fellow is expected to adjust effectively to changing tasks, priorities, and cultural contexts while remaining open to feedback and new learning opportunities.
- Communication - The Fellow should be able to communicate clearly and respectfully in both written and verbal forms, adapting messages to different audiences and cultural settings.
- Teamwork - The Fellow is expected to collaborate effectively with colleagues and partners, contributing to shared goals while respecting diverse perspectives.

### **6. Learning Elements**

At the end of the assignment the fellow will be able to:

- Collect, review, and analyze data related to water management systems, irrigation practices, and relevant policy frameworks.
- Draft technical briefs, background notes, and case studies on water resource and salinity management issues.
- Prepare and deliver supporting materials such as presentations, handouts, and summaries for technical and training events.
- Organize and support the implementation of workshops, training sessions, and knowledge-sharing events.
- Communicate effectively with local stakeholders, including farmers and community representatives, under the guidance of the supervisor.
- Contribute to the preparation of advisory materials promoting sustainable and efficient water-use practices.
- Gain a deeper understanding of sustainable agriculture, climate-resilient water management, and international development cooperation in the context of Kazakhstan and the Central Asia region.

### **7. Content and methodology of the supervision**

Fellows will receive structured and continuous supervision throughout their assignment to ensure meaningful learning and contribution to the team. The supervision approach includes the following key elements:

- Initial Orientation and Briefing
- Work Planning: Fellows will develop an individual work plan in coordination with their supervisor, outlining learning objectives, tasks, and expected deliverables.
- Thematic and Technical Training: Orientation on FAO's work in Kazakhstan and the region, including its approach to climate resilience, sustainable agriculture, and water resource governance.
- Practical Skills Development: Hands-on training in preparing technical briefs, case studies, and background notes. Exposure to the process of organizing and facilitating workshops and training events.
- On-the-Job Learning and Mentorship: Continuous guidance and mentoring from FAO's technical staff and international experts. Opportunities for real-time feedback and reflection.
- Participation in Team Activities: Active participation in team meetings, knowledge exchanges, and peer learning sessions.

## **8. Living conditions in the country**

Astana, the capital city of Kazakhstan, is a modern and rapidly developing urban center known for its unique and futuristic architecture. The city offers a high standard of living with access to various amenities including shopping centers, restaurants, and recreational facilities. The climate is characterized by cold winters and hot summers, so appropriate clothing is necessary. Public transportation is well-developed, making it easy to navigate the city.

Healthcare services in Astana are of a high standard, and there are several international schools and cultural institutions. Overall, Astana provides safe, comfortable and vibrant living environment for international personnel.